

PRODUCT BUILD DISCOVERY DISCUSSION

Finding the Exact Right Thing

A structured record of the team's exploration of purchase uncertainty, trust, choice, and reversibility.

Team

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01 What this document contains

This document captures the team's discovery conversation before jumping into solutions. It combines the questions asked, the team's edited responses, the strongest patterns that emerged, and a polished transcript. The wording has been cleaned for readability, but the underlying claims and uncertainty are preserved.

The discussion was intentionally stopped after a final reframing question. Two earlier prompts were skipped or left unanswered; they are marked clearly rather than filled in.

02 Team and working context

Person	Role	Lens brought to the discussion
Chaitanya Jha	Product lead	Personal fit, identity, quality, taste, reversibility and user experience.
Vinay Khedkar	Tech	Trust, product evidence, performance, quality and practical experimentation.
Keshav Baviskar	Economics	Price, authenticity, comparison effort, payment experience and value.

03 Discussion map

Prompt	Focus	Status
1	A recent purchase where choosing the right thing was difficult	Discussed
2	What does "right product" actually mean?	Discussed
3	Does the problem repeat outside supplements?	Discussed
4	What would make someone switch from their current workaround?	Discussed
5	Who would pay?	Skipped by the team
6	Where is the problem strongest?	Asked, no response recorded
Final	What are users protecting themselves from, and what do they hope to feel?	Discussed

04 Synthesis: what the team seems to believe now

These are interpretations of the team's evidence, not validated market facts. They are useful working hypotheses for the next stage of research.

- **The core problem is not simply discovery.** The team repeatedly described uncertainty about trust, authenticity, personal fit, taste, quality, performance, price and whether a bad decision can be undone.
- **"Right" is personal and contextual.** For one person it means cheap and authentic; for another it means taste and identity fit; for another it means proven quality and low health risk.
- **Trust is not one generic rating.** Personal recommendations and credible communities were more persuasive than anonymous reviews, random sites or opaque AI summaries. Brand recognition also acts as a shortcut for

trust.

- **People want narrowing, not total delegation.** Chaitanya wanted many relevant options presented clearly while keeping the final choice. The desired role is closer to a trusted decision partner than an automatic buyer.
- **Reversibility may be a stronger opportunity than perfect accuracy.** Chaitanya's strongest reframing was to make choices more undoable. That reduces regret without requiring a system to predict the one objectively best product.
- **Comparison itself can be emotionally rewarding.** Keshav described checking all options as troublesome but satisfying because it creates confidence that he did the best he could.
- **Post-purchase contribution is a friction problem.** Chaitanya would recommend a product but would not write a long review. Useful evidence may need to be captured through very low-effort signals.

05 The recurring tensions

Tension	What appeared in the discussion
Price vs. trust and quality	Low price matters, but a suspiciously cheap product can signal fraud, poor quality or a fake.
Choice vs. overload	People want to know they considered the market, but scrolling and reading everything becomes exhausting.
Social proof vs. personal fit	A friend's experience can create confidence, but taste, smell, fit and use case still vary by person.
Personalisation vs. intrusiveness	Deep fit guidance could help, but users may not want to share body measurements or other personal data.
Confidence vs. reversibility	The more expensive or subjective the choice, the more important it becomes to reduce the cost of being wrong.
Identity vs. objective performance	Brand, design and community resonance can influence choice alongside measurable quality or function.

06 Research gaps left open

The team conversation creates promising hypotheses, but it does not yet establish how widespread, frequent or monetisable the problem is. The following questions remain open:

- Do people outside this team experience the same fear of an irreversible or hard-to-undo purchase?
- Which categories combine high downside, subjective fit and low reversibility often enough to create a repeated product habit?
- Will users trust peer evidence if it is structured, verified and matched to their context?
- How much personal information will users share to get better fit or personalisation?
- Is the job frequent enough for repeat use, or is it only valuable for occasional high-consideration purchases?

07 Polished transcript

The following transcript is edited for clarity and flow. It preserves the team members' original claims, examples and notable language. It does not add answers where the original response was unfinished.

Question 1 | Discussed

Tell me about a recent purchase where choosing the right thing was difficult.

Recall the trigger, the options you considered, the sources you consulted, your confidence at the point of purchase and whether you regretted the decision.

Chaitanya - protein powder and shaker

I wanted to buy a protein powder and a shaker. I had recently started going to the gym three days a week, so the purchase was triggered by a real need. I had a specific budget of around Rs. 2,000 for 1 kg. Anything above that was a strong negative, although I could make exceptions. I was also willing to wait a couple of days if buying through Amazon or Flipkart saved me about Rs. 200; protein powder was not urgent.

I compared Nakpro, SuperYou and MuscleBlaze across Flipkart, Amazon, Blinkit and official sites. I had previously tasted Nakpro Malai Kulfi with a friend and found it good, but I was not in the mood for that flavour. The decision involved brand, ingredients and quality, delivery time, price and flavour. I asked a friend for trust, then used Amazon reviews and Reddit threads to understand which flavours people liked.

I wanted someone to tell me the exact brand and its best flavours, and to validate whether the flavour I was considering was one of the brand's better ones. I chose Nakpro Chocolate with about 80% confidence because I could have been stuck with a 1 kg pack that was not chocolatey enough. It turned out to be a good product and I did not regret it. I would recommend it, but writing a full review on Amazon or Reddit feels like too much effort.

"I'd love to recommend it, but writing a whole review on Amazon or Reddit feels too much of an effort."

Vinay - Wellcore creatine

The most recent purchase was creatine from Wellcore. I go to the gym frequently, and my trainer advised me to take creatine because it can support strength and sustained energy during workouts. I searched online but was still unsure. I then contacted friends who use creatine and had tried multiple brands. Since most of them had used and stayed with Wellcore, I chose it.

The main difficulty was whether the product had actually been tried and tested by someone. Online reviews helped, but I was more satisfied by reviews from people I knew personally. A free trial would have reduced the uncertainty because I could have tested multiple brands myself. I did not regret the purchase.

"I was more satisfied when I got the reviews from someone who I know personally."

Keshav - MuscleBlaze protein

I recently wanted to buy protein powder because I had been losing weight and muscle mass and felt weak. I already knew I wanted MuscleBlaze, so I considered MuscleBlaze options on Amazon, Flipkart and the official site. I wanted a 1 kg concentrate wherever I could get it cheapest.

I found cheaper options on Amazon from third-party sellers, but I doubted they might be fake. I also consulted ChatGPT once. The original response ends before the final decision and post-purchase evaluation are recorded.

"I doubted it may be fake."

Question 2 | Discussed

What does the "right product" actually mean to you?

Identify your top criteria, what evidence would change your mind, which sources you trust, your non-negotiables and the tradeoffs you can accept.

Chaitanya

My top three criteria for protein powder were price, taste and quality. Price came first because I am a student, taste came second, and quality still mattered a lot even though I ranked it third. The ideal evidence would be advice from a trusted person who had tasted the exact powder, used it extensively and seen results.

I trusted Reddit a lot, my friend next, Amazon somewhat less and random websites the least. I trusted AI overviews the least because I did not know what they were indexing. I would change my decision if I learned that the quality was questionable or the taste was poor. I would abandon a product if quality control seemed weak or the brand had very low adoption; brand recognition matters. I accepted the possibility of lower quality because it was the cheap protein, and I felt that was a tradeoff I had to accept.

"I just felt that this is like the 'cheap' protein which I have to be okay with."

Vinay

For creatine, the important criteria were genuineness, budget and taste. I initially listed taste first, but the non-negotiable was whether the product was genuine and what substances it actually contained. Budget came next, and taste was the most tradeable factor.

I wanted to know how the product works for people, whether it has side effects and whether there could be any reverse effect on the body. The most trustworthy source was word of mouth from a friend who had used it. If I learned that the product was not legitimate, I would reconsider it even if a trusted friend recommended it. I would not compromise on quality.

"I would not compromise on the quality."

Keshav

For me, the right product meant cheap, original and authentic, with a smooth payment experience. The MuscleBlaze official site was slow, which is why I also visited Amazon and searched elsewhere. My rough priority was a cheap and original product plus a familiar, lag-free payment experience.

I would feel more confident if I knew all the options had been searched and the product was shown as the best available choice, with the sources of information made visible. I trusted the official site and Amazon, but not completely, because products that were unusually cheap might be fake. The original response ends before the final criteria are completed.

Question 3 | Discussed

Does this problem repeat outside supplements?

Think of another category where you made a considered purchase. What uncertainty did you face, how did you resolve it and what happened afterward?

Chaitanya - clothing

I tend to prioritise quality in clothing and other purchases. I may spend more than Rs. 2,000 on a Zara item because it lasts longer and feels more comfortable. I buy fewer items at higher quality. Because I buy less often, I want to know whether I have looked across the options and found the best deal - whether I have hit the jackpot.

If a brand is proven, I usually choose it. Otherwise I may experiment with new and exciting products that feel Gen Z or resonate with my identity, including my music taste. Clothing can represent who you are. When buying from a new online brand, I want help understanding size, measurements, fabric, shrinkage after washing and the company behind the product. If something could understand my body measurements without being intrusive, and could use visual information about the product, that would help.

"People really like to represent themselves via their clothing."

Vinay - perfume

When I bought a perfume, I did not ask anyone for advice. I was unsure about how it would smell and how long it would last. I looked at reviews and the ingredients used. Those were the sources I could check and rely on. The perfume turned out well, and I did not regret the decision.

Keshav - hanging bar

My younger brother and I wanted a hanging bar that was original, reasonably cheap and reliable. On Amazon we saw three broad categories: expensive and high quality, medium price and medium quality, and cheap but less reliable. We chose a medium-priced branded option that seemed closer to the cheaper price while offering more reliability.

The same cheap-versus-original problem appeared as it did with supplements. The payment experience mattered, and the return experience was terrible. The product was not up to the mark, so we had to return it, and it took more than a week on Amazon to get the process through. We regretted the decision.

"The cheap and original problem was seen as the supplement."

Question 4 | Discussed

What would make you switch from your current workaround?

What do you currently do to solve this problem? What is frustrating about it? What would make you try a better approach, reuse it or distrust it?

Chaitanya - clothing comparison

When comparing clothing, I check sizes, colours, graphics and the meaning of the brand. I would like to research more, and Reddit or Instagram resonance can influence me. The frustrating part is filtering everything to fit my budget and then finding alternatives when my size is unavailable. I trust verified signals from other customers.

I would not want to pay for someone to choose exactly what I need. I would rather be presented with a lot of relevant options and choose one myself. Sometimes I am decisive; at other times I can spend two or three hours even when there are only two options. I would try a new product if it had a good sale or promotion, or if the brand and its identity appealed to me. I would reuse a service if it gave me loyalty benefits, coupons, community, consistent quality and good price. I would lose trust if the brand moved away from the niche and customer identity that attracted me.

"I would love that I have been presented a lot of options and I can choose one from that."

Vinay - perfume

For perfume, I read the product description and ingredients, searched Reddit and analysed individual reviews. The most frustrating step was going through posts one by one. It was also difficult to align reviews with my budget: people were reviewing products that cost Rs. 1,200 or more while my budget was around Rs. 500-600.

What was missing was personal trust. I would try something better than my current product if it offered longer performance - for example, six to eight hours instead of around four - at the same price. I would reorder if it

delivered what it promised. If a product makes a promise, it should satisfy at least 80-85% of it; if it delivers less than half, I would distrust it.

"If a product makes a promise, it should satisfy at least 80% to 85% of it."

Keshav - hanging bar

I balanced authenticity and return risk by repeatedly checking prices, brands and options. I would trust a product if it had enough reviews and good stars, a reasonable price - not suspiciously cheap or unusually expensive - and a recognisable brand. The most frustrating step was scrolling through many options. The response ends at this point, so no reuse or distrust threshold was recorded.

Question 5 | Skipped

Who would pay?

A direct monetisation prompt was introduced during the process.

The team rejected this question as too direct and moved on. No response was recorded.

Question 6 | Asked - no response

Where is the problem strongest?

Compare categories and situations by purchase frequency, cost, subjectivity, uncertainty and difficulty of reversing the decision.

The team decided that this was too direct and wanted to finish with one better reframing question. No response was recorded.

Question Final | Discussed

What are users really trying to protect themselves from - and what are they hoping to feel after making the choice?

Explore fear of wasting money, looking foolish or losing status, missing a better option, being unable to undo the decision, losing time and not trusting one's own judgment. Complete the sentence: "The real problem is not finding products. It is the fear of _____, while trying to achieve _____."

Chaitanya

I believe the real underlying fear is being unable to undo the decision. That is a major one. Missing a better option and wasting money are also important. Everyone is trying to achieve more accuracy, but accuracy is not the best metric. Alignment of taste matters too.

Quality can sometimes be taken for a toss, but there are fundamental things that people cannot undo. Some decisions are reversible, but people do not reverse them because the process is too difficult. Innovation could make certain choices undoable when people previously thought they were irreversible.

"It's just a matter of innovation where people can be able to undo certain things that they thought were not possible."

Vinay

The real problem is not simply finding products; it comes down to several core fears. First is wasting money. When people buy something expensive, such as a television, refrigerator or car, they want it to fulfil their requirements rather than fail after the purchase.

Second is looking foolish and protecting status within a local community or social circle. Third is missing a better option at the same price point, which can create guilt or regret. Fourth is being unable to undo an expensive decision. Losing time can matter in other contexts, but not as much in this situation. Ultimately, people want a good-quality product that genuinely fulfils the reason they are buying it.

"The real problem is not simply finding products; it comes down to several core fears."

Keshav

The real problem is not finding the right product. It is that you generally trust yourself more and want to check all the options yourself. Going through every option becomes troublesome, but you do it because you want the cheapest and most authentic choice. It also gives you satisfaction because you know you did the best you could. Tools such as AI can help with this process.

"You do it because you want to find the cheapest, most authentic option, and it gives you the satisfaction of knowing you've done the best you can."

08 Closing synthesis

Across the examples, the team is not describing a universal shopping assistant that simply finds the objectively best item. The stronger pattern is a decision-support problem: people want to reduce the chance of regret, verify that the choice is authentic and suitable, preserve their own agency, and feel that the decision was defensible.

The most distinctive product direction suggested by the discussion is therefore not "more recommendations" alone. It is a combination of trusted narrowing, context-matched evidence and a credible path to recover when the choice turns out to be wrong.

This is the end of the recorded discovery session. No solution concepts, monetisation answers or category rankings have been inserted into the transcript.